

E074

Agile for Software Engineering

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

Two stakeholders disagree on whether a reporting feature or a mobile login should be built next. One of them is the company's longest-serving vice president. Who decides the order of the Product Backlog?

- A. The Product Owner.
- B. The Scrum Master.
- C. The longest-serving vice president.
- D. The developers, by majority vote.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

Midway through a two-week sprint, a sales director who just closed a large deal asks developers directly to start a new feature today. The sprint goal is still valid. What should happen?

- A. The Scrum Master cancels the sprint.
- B. Send the request to the Product Owner to add and order in the Product Backlog; protect the sprint goal.
- C. Refuse, because nothing may ever change during a sprint.
- D. Developers start it right away and pause sprint work.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A team in a new open-plan office keeps finding that code reviews take three days. They want to talk about why and agree on one change to try next sprint. Which event fits?

- A. Daily Scrum
- B. Sprint Review
- C. Sprint Retrospective
- D. A meeting about the office layout

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

What is the main purpose of the Sprint Review?

- A. Plan the tasks for the next sprint.
- B. Discuss how the team can work better together.
- C. Inspect the increment with stakeholders and adapt the Product Backlog.
- D. Give managers a status report on each developer.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A team that recently switched to a new code editor agrees that every backlog item must have passing unit tests, peer-reviewed code, and updated release notes before it counts as finished. What is this agreement?

- A. A coding standard for the new editor.
- B. The Definition of Done.
- C. Acceptance criteria.
- D. The Sprint Goal.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

For a password-reset story, the team writes: “The reset link expires after 30 minutes.” What is this?

- A. An acceptance criterion for that story.
- B. A retrospective action item.
- C. Part of the Definition of Done.
- D. A Sprint Goal.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A team completed 22, 26, and 24 story points in its last three sprints. The team across the hall averages 40 points. About 120 points remain in the release backlog. About how many sprints should this team forecast?

- A. 3 sprints
- B. 72 sprints
- C. About 4.6 sprints
- D. 5 sprints

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team must finish 150 points in 5 sprints. What average velocity would that require?

- A.** 145 points per sprint
- B.** 5 points per sprint
- C.** 30 points per sprint
- D.** 750 points per sprint

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A Kanban board with five columns and color-coded cards has 30 items in progress. The team finishes about 10 items per week. What is the average cycle time?

- A.** 3 weeks
- B.** 40 weeks
- C.** About 0.33 weeks
- D.** 300 weeks

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team finishes 10 items per week and wants average cycle time of 2 weeks. What WIP limit fits?

- A.** 0.2 items
- B.** 20 items
- C.** 5 items
- D.** 12 items

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A manager at a firm that recently won a state contract says, “We’re Agile now, so we don’t write any documentation.” What does the Agile Manifesto actually say?

- A.** Documentation is valued more than working software.
- B.** No documentation should ever be written.
- C.** Every story must have full design documents.
- D.** Working software is valued more than comprehensive documentation, but documentation still has value.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A new Scrum Master, who holds two certifications, starts each morning by assigning specific tasks to each developer and checking their progress. What is the main problem?

- A. The Product Owner should assign the tasks instead.
- B. The Scrum Master needs a third certification.
- C. No problem; the Scrum Master is the team’s manager.
- D. Developers should self-manage their work; the Scrum Master should coach and remove impediments.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

Two stakeholders disagree on whether a reporting feature or a mobile login should be built next. ~~One of them is the company's longest-serving vice president.~~ Who decides the order of the Product Backlog?

Target word: backlog ordering authority **Decides:** The Product Owner is accountable for ordering.

A	Correct	Owens ordering after hearing stakeholders.
B	Confusion set	Facilitates but does not own priorities.
C	Camouflage	Seniority does not give backlog authority.
D	Adjacent category	Developers own how to build, not what comes next.

2. Answer B Concept 2

Midway through a two-week sprint, a sales director ~~who just closed a large deal~~ asks developers directly to start a new feature today. The sprint goal is still valid. What should happen?

Target word: handling a mid-sprint request **Decides:** The goal is still valid; new work goes through the Product Owner.

A	Confusion set	Only the Product Owner can cancel, and only if the goal is obsolete.
B	Correct	Keeps focus while the Product Owner weighs the request.
C	Absolute language	Scope can be clarified with the Product Owner; the request can go to the backlog.
D	Inverted operation	Breaks the sprint goal for an outside request.

3. Answer C Concept 3

A team ~~in a new open-plan office~~ keeps finding that code reviews take three days. They want to talk about why and agree on one change to try next sprint. Which event fits?

Target word: event for process improvement **Decides:** The topic is how the team works.

A	Adjacent category	A 15-minute check on progress toward the sprint goal.
B	Confusion set	Inspects the product increment with stakeholders.
C	Correct	Inspects and improves the team's process.
D	Camouflage	The office is not the review delay.

4. Answer C Concept 3 · transfer

What is the main purpose of the Sprint Review?

Target word: purpose of the Review **Decides:** Stakeholders inspect the increment.

A	Confusion set	That is Sprint Planning.
B	Inverted operation	That is the Retrospective.
C	Correct	Product-focused inspection and adaptation.
D	Adjacent category	Scrum events are not individual status reports.

5. Answer B Concept 4

A team ~~that recently switched to a new code editor~~ agrees that every backlog item must have passing unit tests, peer-reviewed code, and updated release notes before it counts as finished. What is this agreement?

Target word: classify the quality bar **Decides:** It applies to every item.

A	Camouflage	The editor does not define done.
B	Correct	A shared bar for all items.
C	Confusion set	Those are specific to one story.
D	Adjacent category	The goal is the sprint's objective, not a quality bar.

6. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

For a password-reset story, the team writes: "The reset link expires after 30 minutes." What is this?

Target word: classify a story-specific condition **Decides:** Applies to this one story.

A	Correct	A condition for one story.
B	Confusion set	Retro items improve process.
C	Inverted operation	The DoD applies to every item, not one feature's rule.
D	Adjacent category	Too narrow for a sprint objective.

7. Answer D Concept 5

A team completed 22, 26, and 24 story points in its last three sprints. ~~The team across the hall averages 40 points.~~ About 120 points remain in the release backlog. About how many sprints should this team forecast?

Target word: forecast from own velocity **Decides:** Average velocity = 24.

A	Camouflage	Uses the other team's velocity.
B	Inverted operation	Multiplies instead of dividing.
C	Wrong stem number	Uses the single best sprint (26).
D	Correct	$120 / 24 = 5$.

8. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

A team must finish 150 points in 5 sprints. What average velocity would that require?

Target word: solve for velocity **Decides:** Points ÷ sprints.

A	Confusion set	Subtracts.
B	Wrong stem number	The number of sprints.
C	Correct	$150 / 5 = 30$.
D	Inverted operation	Multiplies.

9. Answer A Concept 6

A Kanban board ~~with five columns and color-coded cards~~ has 30 items in progress. The team finishes about 10 items per week. What is the average cycle time?

Target word: cycle time by Little's Law **Decides:** $WIP \div \text{throughput}$.

A	Correct	$30 / 10 = 3$.
B	Adjacent category	Adds the two numbers.
C	Confusion set	$\text{Throughput} \div WIP$.
D	Inverted operation	Multiplies.

10. Answer B Concept 6 · transfer

A team finishes 10 items per week and wants average cycle time of 2 weeks. What WIP limit fits?

Target word: solve for WIP **Decides:** $WIP = \text{cycle time} \times \text{throughput}$.

A	Confusion set	$\text{Cycle time} \div \text{throughput}$.
B	Correct	$2 \times 10 = 20$.
C	Inverted operation	Divides throughput by cycle time.
D	Adjacent category	Adds the numbers.

11. Answer D Concept 7

A manager ~~at a firm that recently won a state contract~~ says, "We're Agile now, so we don't write any documentation." What does the Agile Manifesto actually say?

Target word: meaning of a manifesto value **Decides:** Items on the right are still valued.

A	Inverted operation	Reverses the value.
B	Absolute language	Misreads "over" as "instead of."
C	Adjacent category	A heavy process rule the manifesto does not require.
D	Correct	The manifesto ranks, it does not ban.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A new Scrum Master, ~~who holds two certifications~~, starts each morning by assigning specific tasks to each developer and checking their progress. What is the main problem?

Target word: Scrum Master stance **Decides:** Developers self-manage their sprint work.

A	Adjacent category	The Product Owner orders the backlog, not daily tasks.
B	Camouflage	Credentials do not fix the stance.
C	Confusion set	The Scrum Master is not a line manager.
D	Correct	Servant leadership, not task assignment.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	0	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	2	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	10	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Product Owner owns backlog order	The Product Owner is accountable for ordering the Product Backlog to maximize value; stakeholders influence, but the Product Owner decides.	Letting the loudest or most senior stakeholder set priority.	Competing requests and “who decides what comes next?”
2	Protecting the sprint	New requests go to the Product Owner and the Product Backlog; sprint scope may be clarified with the Product Owner but the Sprint Goal is protected, and only the Product Owner can cancel a sprint.	Developers dropping sprint work for a manager’s request, or thinking nothing can ever change.	A mid-sprint request from outside the team.
3	Purpose of each Scrum event	Sprint Planning sets the goal and plan; the Daily Scrum inspects progress toward the goal; the Sprint Review inspects the increment with stakeholders; the Retrospective improves how the team works.	Using the Review to fix process, or the Daily Scrum as a status report to a manager.	What is being inspected and who is there.
4	Definition of Done vs. acceptance criteria	The Definition of Done is a quality bar for every item; acceptance criteria are the conditions for one specific story.	Calling a story-specific condition part of the Definition of Done.	“Every item must...” vs. “this story must...”
5	Velocity for forecasting	Use a team’s own recent average velocity to forecast; do not compare velocities across teams or treat it as a target.	Using another team’s velocity or the single best sprint.	Past sprint points and a remaining backlog.
6	Kanban WIP limits and Little’s Law	Average cycle time = work in progress ÷ throughput; lowering WIP shortens cycle time.	Starting more work to finish faster.	Items in progress, items finished per period, and a time question.
7	Agile Manifesto values	The manifesto values the items on the left more, while still valuing the items on the right.	Reading “working software over documentation” as “no documentation.”	Someone citing Agile to drop an activity entirely.
8	Scrum Master as servant leader	The Scrum Master coaches, facilitates, and removes impediments; developers self-manage who does what.	Treating the Scrum Master as a task-assigning manager.	A Scrum Master directing daily work.

Course scope (public description): This course introduces the application of Agile methodology in software engineering, focusing on Scrum, Kanban, and collaborative team practices. Learners apply agile leadership frameworks, communication strategies, and agile processes to contribute effectively to software engineering projects and foster an agile team culture. Successful completion of this course may support learners in pursuing Agile or Scrum related certifications offered by the Scrum Alliance.